PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

March 12, 2026
Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Teaching, Learning and Enrollment Committee meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller (Committee Chair), Virginia La Forte, Christy Splitt

District Student Council Representatives: Mel Schuller and Eve Thompson

Board Members (Non-Committee): Board Chair Eddie Wang; and Directors Stephanie Engelsman and Patte Sullivan

Attendees:

Kristina Howard – Senior Chief of Academics
Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong – Superintendent
Margaret Calvert – Assistant Superintendent, School Planning and Modernization
Dr. Renard Adams – Chief Accountability and Equity Officer
Dr. Isaac Cardona – Chief of Schools
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education

Call to Order and Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:34 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller.

Public Comment

- Chris Kennedy: Cleveland Youth Track Coach - Would like to consider allowing students to participate in any high school cluster youth sports team they want in order to be with their peers.
- Arianna Avena: Buckman parent who spoke about the cuts to the arts at Buckman schools would like the Student Investment Account funding to be directed towards arts teachers positions.
- Britt Appleton: She would like the Board to direct the District to mandate using the diversity exceptions to seniority assignments.

Continuity of Instruction

Chief Cardona gave an overview of the planning for continuity of instruction for students at a school when a large cohort of their peers are away for an extended period of time. He gave examples of how principals plan for substitute coverage and curriculum review. There were questions about who funds substitute teachers for extended trips that last for more than a week. The Committee also questioned whether or not the Districtwide Advocacy and Fundraising Policy could allow for the funding of substitute teachers.

Growing Great Schools

Committee Chair Chase-Miller opened with remarks about the gravity of the topic and committed to transparent conversations. Superintendent Armstrong expressed appreciation for the statement.

Staff provided data on current and future enrollment trends and provided some background history of some of the impacts to previous boundary reconfiguring changes and opening of new schools, like Ockley Green Middle School. They also shared some lessons learned from previous enrollment and boundary processes like the Southeast Guiding Coalition (SEGC). Staff provided some past examples of engagement structures, and the framework analysis for SEGC and District-wide Boundary Review Advisory Committee (DBRAC), as well as a framework used by Denver Public Schools.

Board members had an opportunity to share some initial thinking about their guiding principles:

- Include focus option programs and K-8 schools when making recommendations. For example, does a focus option result in a neighborhood being underenrolled.
- Protect and ensure strong neighborhood schools.
- Use an equity approach in decision making and include consideration of any unintended consequences.
- Consider if there are disproportionate impacts to lower income neighborhood schools that are close enough to a focus option that pulls away families.
- Avoid splitting feeder patterns whenever possible.
- Consolidate schools over closing them.
- Consider building deferred maintenance in a recommendation.
- Find out what people want in their schools.
- Look at per student costs and move away from inefficient models.
- Preference for a whole city approach.
- Ensure there are transition plans in place.

There were questions about the lottery system for focus options schools and whether or not families opted out of Portland Public Schools if they did not get their student into a program that required winning the lottery to enroll. Board members also asked if there were known reasons for the decline post pandemic and requested capture rate information, and comparison data for birth rates and kindergarten enrollment rates five years later. There was also requested middle school transition data, as well as data on students who enter middle school after choosing other options for elementary. There was also a request to understand if the change to the policy on early entry into kindergarten has had an impact in enrollment.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

The Committee requested that they have an opportunity to understand possible reasons for the decline in enrollment and wondered if the Portland State University Population Research Center could be at an upcoming meeting.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at 6:10 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Manager, Board of Education
Portland Public Schools
